

Class Notes: Class Mammalia

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

Diagnostic Mammalian Features

Found in a wide variety of habitats — polar ice, deserts, mountains, forests, grasslands, dark caves; adapted to fly, swim or walk. Presence of mammary glands (producing milk for young) is a unique mammalian character; respiration by lungs.

Reproduction and Examples

Two pairs of limbs adapted for walking, running, climbing, burrowing, swimming or flying; skin covered by hair; external ears (pinnae) present. Heart four-chambered; homoiothermous; sexes separate; internal fertilisation; mostly viviparous (exception: Platypus is oviparous); direct development. Examples: Ornithorhynchus (platypus, oviparous), Macropus (kangaroo), Pteropus (flying fox), Camelus (camel), Macaca (monkey), Rattus (rat), Canis (dog), Felis (cat), Elephas (elephant), Equus (horse), Delphinus (dolphin), Balaenoptera (blue whale), Panthera tigris (tiger), Panthera leo (lion).